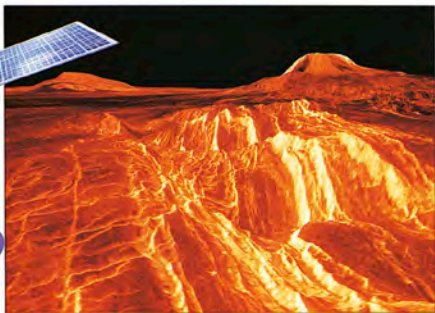
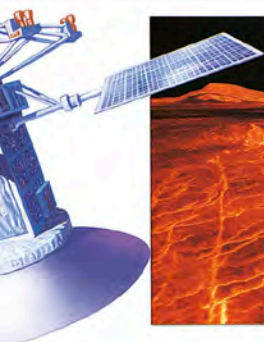


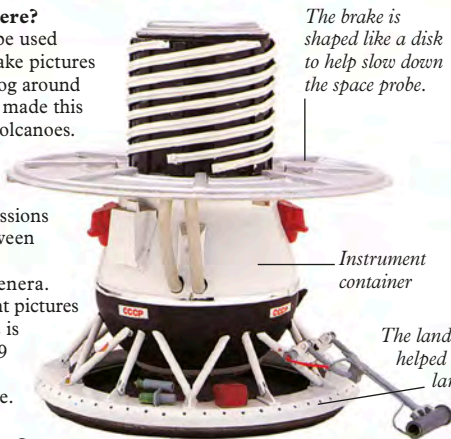


Wish you were here?

The Magellan probe used radar cameras to take pictures through the thick fog around Venus. Computers made this 3-D image of the volcanoes.

Venus Venera

Several Russian missions went to Venus between 1961 and 1984 in a program called Venera. The spacecraft sent pictures back to Earth. This is the part of Venera 9 that went down to Venus by parachute.



The brake is shaped like a disk to help slow down the space probe.

Instrument container

The landing ring helped to make the landing soft.

Hot orange

Venus has a dense atmosphere that traps heat from the sun. It is the hottest planet of all—so hot it could melt lead! It has a bright orange sky with flashes of lightning. Earth spins around once every 24 hours, but Venus spins very slowly—once every 244 days!



Venera 9 Venus landing

The space probe was in a capsule on the Venera spacecraft.



The capsule fell through the atmosphere of Venus.



The heat shield covers separated and fell off.



The probe was slowed down by a small parachute.



Three larger parachutes were used for the final stage.

After a safe landing, the television cameras and instruments were switched on.

